Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 1NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠7

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥8

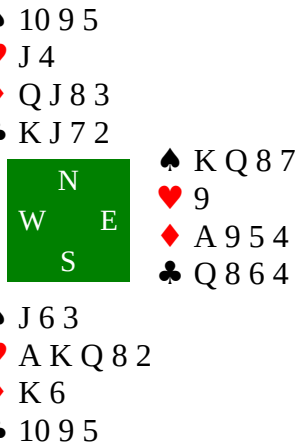
Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠10

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥4

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			

1NT by North
Lead: ♠7

SOUTH has a solid 1♥ opening, 14 points and five trumps.

NORTH must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least 11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

SOUTH doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 5
♥ J 10 9 3
♦ A 10 6 2
♣ K J 8 3

♠ J 9 6 2
♥ K Q 7 5
♦ 8 3
♣ 10 7 4

♠ K Q 10 7 3
♥ A 4 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A 6

♠ A 8 4
♥ 8 6
♦ K Q J 4
♣ Q 9 5 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2♠			
All Pass			

2♠ by East
Lead: ♥8

EAST has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

WEST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠, passed by EAST.

WEST does not consider showing the ♥s, first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K J 4 ♥ K Q 9 2 ♦ A Q 5 ♣ K 10 8	
♠ Q 10 9 7 6 5 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 8 ♣ 7 6 3 2	N W E S	♠ 2 ♥ J 10 8 5 4 ♦ 10 7 3 2 ♣ A 9 4
	♠ A 8 3 ♥ A 7 ♦ K J 9 6 4 ♣ Q J 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♠10

With balanced distribution and 16 points SOUTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

NORTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that SOUTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 5 3 ♥ K 8 5 4 3 ♦ K J 4 ♣ 10 6 4	
♠ K 4 ♥ Q 10 6 ♦ 8 5 3 2 ♣ Q 9 8 5		♠ Q J 10 9 6 ♥ A 7 ♦ A Q 6 ♣ A K 7
	♠ A 8 7 2 ♥ J 9 2 ♦ 10 9 7 ♣ J 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥4

EAST is right at the maximum for a 1♠ opening bid - one more point and he would have opened 2♣.

WEST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response. She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

EAST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.